CONNECT DAILY

Thursday 12 November 2026
themapsproject.com

A daily scan of national and South Yorkshire developments in education policy, inclusion, SEND, behaviour and accountability — weighted to primary and evidence sources, with links and a clear "so what for your school" line on the items that matter.

Useful? Forward it to a colleague. To join the circulation or partner with the network, get in touch.

TOP LINE

- Another quiet 24-48 hours nationally - no new DfE, Ofsted, safeguarding, SEND or funding announcement cleared the corroboration bar, so today's edition stays short rather than padded.
- Locally, the Talbot Specialist School dispute (the Norton Lees SEND school maintained by Sheffield City Council) remains unresolved, with the NEU's six called strike days continuing through the month.

  → **For your school:** *Keep an eye on further strike days this month if you route SEND placements or respite support through Talbot.*

- Reminder: DfE's call for evidence on exclusion reform closes in 7 days, on 19 November.

DATES FOR THE DIARY

16-20 Nov 2026 — Anti-Bullying Week 2026 - 'Break the Silence' theme; Odd Socks Day opens the week on 16 Nov.

19 Nov 2026 — DfE's call for evidence on school exclusion reform (behaviour strategies, in-school units, managed moves) closes - 7 days away.

31 Dec 2026 — Deadline for every mainstream school in England to publish its first statutory inclusion strategy statement.

Nov 2026 (exact day tbc) — DfE due to publish autumn 2025/26 suspensions and permanent exclusions statistics for England.

SHEFFIELD & SOUTH YORKSHIRE

- **Talbot dispute still unresolved as strike days continue.** The NEU's dispute with Sheffield City Council over workload, safe working practices and governance at Talbot Specialist School remains unresolved more than a week after the first walkout on 5 November; the union has called six strike days across the month in total, and no settlement has been reported. (The Star / Yorkshire Post)

  → **For your school:** *Worth flagging to any mainstream colleagues who route SEND placements or respite support through Talbot, in case further strike days this month disrupt provision.*

JARGON-BUSTER · INCLUSION STRATEGY STATEMENT

A new statutory duty landing on every mainstream school in England.

By 31 December 2026, schools must publish a short (around 500-word) statement on their website setting out what they're doing - and spending, including any Inclusive Mainstream Fund money - to remove barriers to learning and participation. DfE issued a template in June; statements must be reviewed annually.

MAPS IN PRACTICE – TOOL SPOTLIGHT: SCHOOL+

A strong inclusion strategy is only as good as the cohort picture beneath it.

School+ is the MAPs cohort-vulnerability framework — it maps who your at-risk pupils are and why, giving your inclusion strategy an evidence base rather than a wish list. Explore School+

SOURCES MONITORED

Weighted official- and evidence-first. X is monitored for early signals from official accounts and named commentators, and corroborated against a primary source before anything is included.

Source	Type	What we track
OFFICIAL & STATUTORY		
DfE / GOV.UK	Government	Policy, funding, statutory guidance and statistics
Ofsted	Government	Inspection framework, report cards, annual report
Explore Education Statistics	Government data	Exclusions, suspensions, attendance, census data
House of Commons Library	Parliament	Neutral briefings on bills and policy
RESEARCH & EVIDENCE		
Education Endowment Foundation	Research	Evidence-based guidance, incl. inclusive teaching
NFER	Research	Assessment, workforce, disadvantage
Education Policy Institute	Think tank	Policy analysis and the disadvantage gap
Institute for Fiscal Studies	Think tank	School funding and spending analysis
FFT Education Datalab	Data analysis	Data-driven analysis of attainment and exclusions
INCLUSION & PREVENTION SPECIALISTS		
The Difference	Charity	Whole-school inclusion; "Who's Losing Learning?"
IPPR	Think tank	Lost learning, exclusions, SEND reform
Youth Endowment Fund	Research	What works to prevent youth violence & exclusion
Centre for Social Justice	Think tank	Exclusion tracker and social-mobility policy
Whole School SEND	Network	SEND practice, resources and reviews
SECTOR PRESS & COMMENTARY		
Schools Week	Press	Breaking sector news and investigations
Tes	Press	Practice, policy and workforce
The Guardian (Education)	Press	National coverage and comment
X (monitored)	Social	DfE, Ofsted, EEF and named voices — corroborated before use
LOCAL & REGIONAL		
The Star (Sheffield)	Local press	Local schools and Ofsted outcomes
Sheffield City Council	Local government	Council decisions, funding and local strategy
South Yorkshire MCA & Careers Hub	Regional	Regional skills, careers and funding

Connect Daily is part of Sheffield Connect. Compiled by Andy Marsden, Sector Inclusion Lead.

For circulation across the network and partners. Figures reflect the latest published data at the date of this brief.